

14 A.I.

This is the one field that is seeing so much progress, that we can't even begin to scratch the surface if we dedicated the entire cover story to it. Pretty much all of the future concepts we've listed here have some element of A.I. supporting them, and it's going to be big business too.

Digital Assistants were big in 2016, but they weren't perfect, and we think 2017 will see even more of them launched, and all of the billions of interactions they have with people

course). Humans can have a bad day, and their judgement can be clouded, but software is always clear about the outcome. Not to say that software is perfect, which is why Dalio believes that up to 75% of management can be done by software, but the remaining 25% will have to be managed by some very smart humans. The only bit that confuses us is, if the software will manage hiring and firing...

doesn't that make the software 100% in charge?

The rise of AI has even the office of the President of the US involved, because they're worried about the impact to the economy when A.I. takes over the jobs of millions of Americans soon. This is also very worrying for countries that rely a lot on outsourcing, such as China, and also India. The only thing cheaper and harder working than a Chinese factory worker is a robot,

at least in the long run. We think that in 2017 we will see the start of the effects of A.I. on global economies, and it might not turn out too well for some of us.

15 MEDICAL

This is the field which possibly gets the most funding for research, and with good reason too, because humans want to live longer (if not forever) and the fountain of youth is the ultimate goal of mankind.

One of the ways to accomplish a longer life, especially for people suffering organ failure, is to have artificial

organs take over the job, either permanently, or temporarily till a donor is found. In 2016 we were wowed by 25-year old Stan Larkin, who carried an external artificial heart in a backpack for

over a year-and-a-half. He even played basketball without a heart inside his body, which would be unthinkable just a few years ago.

In 2017, the first artificial pancreas will go on sale, which is excellent news for people suffering from type 1 diabetes. The little gadget will constantly check blood sugar levels and

inject insulin accordingly, thus taking away the need for the patient to do that themselves. This should also reduce the risk of death because of incorrect dosage, such as taking insulin when the blood sugar is low.

However, the big news is not just artificial organs, but the possibility exists that we will be able to do entire head transplants soon. Yes, you read that right, in a few years you might be able to go to a doctor and get a totally new body (but keep the same head)– if you thought sex change surgeries needed therapy, imagine waking up with someone else's body... literally!

Of course some diseases might not need whole new donor bodies, and this is where gene therapy comes in,

DOCTOR'S ORDERS

<http://dgit.in/Heartbackpck>

<http://dgit.in/HybrdLoop>

<http://dgit.in/GeminiSC>

<http://dgit.in/GeneThrpy>



Roboy, an advance humanoid robot developed at the University of Zurich

from across the globe will train them to be smarter, and thus make them even more invaluable in the long run. However, it's not just personal assistants that will go artificial, but also many jobs, and surprisingly, they're not repetitive jobs of assembly line workers and the like, but jobs that you would think could never be done without humans...

When the world's largest hedge fund (Bridgewater Associates) says it wants to start building and trialling software to take over quite a few tasks from humans, you sit up and take notice. The founder, Ray Dalio wants the company to run according to his vision, even after he's gone, and feels that software is the only way to achieve that. What will the software handle? Hiring and firing of people, everyday decision making and management, and even strategic decision making (all in line with the company's vision of

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A French made artificial heart

especially when it comes to genetic flaws that make us prone to maladies. Blindness is one such genetic problem, and a company called Spark Therapeutics is expected to get a license from the US FDA in 2017 to start gene therapy to try and cure a genetic type of blindness called inherited retinal dystrophies. And that's just scratching the surface of the mind-blowing medical marvels we can expect to see starting in 2017. Fingers crossed!